> to represent universal values. Barbarians might therefore acquire ‘civilization’. Combined with the eighteenth-century belief that human misery was to some degree preventable, the idea that progress could be shared by all contributed to the notion of the ‘civilizing’ mission where secular reformers, even enlightened believers, could share the missionary zeal and rally around the standard of ‘civilization’ to carry the light of ‘civilization’ to dark places.[13]

These extracts from Gong’s work capture the sum and substance of Christian European coloniality. Gong even cites the life and views of Cecil Rhodes, the British diamond magnate from South Africa who instituted the Rhodes Scholarship, as an illustration of the movement from Christian civilisation to secularised Christian civilisation. This is corroborated by other scholars as well.[14]

Those in Bharat who aspire to the Rhodes Scholarship or are beneficiaries of it and hold forth on ‘constitutional morality’ and ‘transformative constitutionalism’ should consider reading more of Rhodes’ views and those of other like-minded individuals who saw national constitutions as conduits to advance the cause of secularised Christian civilisational values. That would be a good decolonial beginning since it is well-known that scholarships, such as Rhodes, were typically employed by the Christian European coloniser to groom and co-opt natives into his worldview and values. The objective was that such Westernised natives would return to their countries of origin to ‘reform’ their fellow natives by instilling respect for ‘constitutional morality’ and ‘civilisation’.

Coming back to the standard of civilisation, as Europe reached the heights of its colonisation, an ‘international society’ began to take shape. The system bestowed certain benefits upon its Christian and European members, and colonised societies too sought to reorient themselves in order to be accepted as ‘civilised’ members of the international society and enjoy the benefits of a Eurocentric global order. Following were the broad legal requirements of the Standard of Civilisation, as enumerated by Gong:

> 1. A ‘civilised’ State guarantees basic rights, that is, life, dignity and property; freedom of travel, commerce and religion, especially that of foreign nationals;
> 2. A ‘civilised’ State exists as an organised political bureaucracy with some efficiency in running the state machinery, and with some